The Means of Accomplishment of Glorious Hevajra

Śrīhevajrasādhana · Toh 1249 · Derge Tengyur

དཔལ་དགྱེ་པ་རྡོ་རྗེའི་སྒྲུབ་ཐབས

The Means of Accomplishment of Glorious Hevajra, known in Sanskrit as the Śrīhevajrasādhana and in Tibetan as Pal Gyepa Dorjé Drubtap, is a short verse sādhana, a practice manual for meditating on the deity Hevajra in his one-faced, two-armed form as Heruka, embracing his consort Nairātmyā. In concise verses it leads the practitioner through visualizing himself as the deity, inviting and merging with the wisdom deities, the inner yoga of caṇḍālī and great bliss, aspiration prayers, torma and other offerings, and carrying the practice into daily life, sleep and waking. Its colophon attributes it to the Indian master Anaṅgavajra and records that it was translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Vajrapāṇi and the Tibetan translator Maben Chöbar. It is Toh 1249 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the commentaries on the tantras, among the ritual and practice texts of the Hevajra cycle.

In the language of India: śrīhevajrasādhanaṃ. In the language of Tibet: The Means of Accomplishment of Glorious Hevajra.

Homage to glorious Vajraḍāka.

The hero who wears a garland of skulls,
Who dances so as to pervade the sky,
Whose form is nondual with Nairātmyā:
To that Great Bliss I bow.

Reality is hard to find, and harder still than that
Is a guru who shows the instructions.
The way of mantra, from which one's own and others' aims arise:
Rely upon this path that benefits beings!

The mantrin endowed with the eight qualities,
Seated upon a comfortable seat,
Should imagine mind itself in his own heart,
And with its light purify himself and sentient beings.
Then he should gaze upon the vast source of phenomena.
From the transformation of the unchanging itself
Comes glorious Vajra Heruka,
With one face and two arms, deep black,

His dancing foot pressing down the sun,
Adorned with the six seals,
Holding vajra and skull cup in right and left,
Embraced at the neck by Nairātmyā,
Who holds a curved knife and a skull cup,
With three eyes, his hair blazing upward.
As one whose nature is filled with bliss,
So one should meditate on oneself.

With the light of the wisdom being at the heart,
Summon the accomplished deities,
And after making offerings and so forth,
Imagine them as nondual with oneself.
Then they confer empowerment and bless;
Or else, please them with offerings.

Through the union of the two organs,
First, worship the buddhas.
Having taken up that sublime great bliss,
Let it rest at the root of the navel,
And drink the nectar itself:
Thus his body arises completely pure.

With Caṇḍālī blazing at the navel,
The five Sugatas are burned,
And Locanā and the others are burned as well;
From the burned haṃ the hare-marked moon drips.
Without beginning, end or middle,
Neither saṃsāra nor nirvāṇa,
In which neither self nor other exists:
The light is supreme great bliss.

The yogin endowed with this should, at the very beginning, utter the blessing of truth, saying, "May the vajrayoginīs who roam the sacred places and lands bless me!" And at the end he should also say:

The light of wisdom, exceedingly profound,
The vajra essence, like the sky,
Free of dust, bestowing the ultimate, peaceful:
My father is myself.

Here, born in the family, endowed with the pledges,
Holding Hevajra with passion,
Respectful to the guru, compassionate:
So may I be in birth after birth.
My hands sounding vajra and bell,
Reciting this profound Dharma,
Sharing food in common with the fluid of the consort:
So may I become in birth after birth.

Then, having given the torma,
Make supplication for the aims one desires.
Reciting the mantra of the Sugata,
Move about in the yoga of the deity.
Always gather disciples,
Always teach the sublime Dharma,
Always protect all sentient beings,
Always worship glorious Heruka.
Make tsatsas, fire offerings and sacrifices;
Make water offerings with one's own giving.
With the guru and the Sugatas before you,
Having polished and cleansed the maṇḍala,
Make offerings and praise, and request them to depart.
Offer the four continents once each day.

Likewise in the other breaks between sessions,
One should bless oneself.
Sitting cross-legged, with the focus stable,
The mind fixed unmoving on the tip of the nose,
Even when busy, taking a moment's pause,
Even a householder should meditate.
Even when engaged in the modes of conduct,
Meditate on them as like an illusion and a dream.
Lie down to sleep with the coemergent mind;
Rise up with passion for the welfare of beings.
Call it to mind spontaneously,
And practice yoga in a spontaneous way.
Like a bird that travels through the sky,
The mantrin dwells without attachment.
May one not be overcome by distraction elsewhere,

By a mind of attachment, or by sleep!

This means of accomplishment is precious,
And the yogin too is fortunate.
Through my having condensed it well,
May all who are virtuous delight in it!

The Means of Accomplishment of One-Faced Glorious Heruka, composed by the master Anaṅgavajra, is complete. It was translated by the Indian preceptor Vajrapāṇi and the Tibetan translator Maben Chöbar.

Translator's Notes

• In the homage, the text's □□□□ ("māra") is read as □□□□ ("I bow"), which the line evidently requires. Locanā heads the four goddesses who are burned along with the five Sugatas. The line rendered "With the guru and the Sugatas before you, having polished and cleansed the maṇḍala" refers to the maṇḍala offering; the exact sense of □□□□□□□□ is uncertain. "My father is myself" translates □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as it stands.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.